



2027 SUMMER CAMP — LEADERS GUIDE



PIRATE CREW ADVENTURES · “Ahoy, Mateys!” · BSA Scout Weeks

Session Dates	Week 1: Jun 1–5 (Tue–Sat) · Week 2: Jun 6–12 (Sun–Sat) · Week 3: Jun 13–19 (Sun–Sat)
Staff Training	May 28–30, 2027
Property	Camp Lawton · Catalina Council, BSA · USFS National Forest Land
Camp Contact	Through Catalina Council office
Check-In	Arrival day 1:00–3:00 PM · Back vehicles into spaces · No vehicles inside camp
Check-Out	Final Saturday by 11:30 AM
Theme	Pirate Crew Adventures · Campsites = Ships · Dining Hall = Galley
NCAP Status	NCAP 2026 Compliant · Short-Term Camp Administrator assessment on file
Future Dates	2028: BSA Weeks May 30–Jun 17 · Cub Weekend Jun 23–25 (Fri–Sun) 2029: BSA Weeks May 29–Jun 16 · Cub Weekend Jun 22–24 (Fri–Sun)

CRITICAL INFORMATION — READ BEFORE ARRIVAL

- **NO AQUATICS:** Camp Lawton has no pool or waterfront. There is no swimming, boating, or water activity program. Do not bring swim gear expecting an aquatics program.
- **NATIONAL FOREST LAND:** Camp operates under a USFS Special Use Permit. Leave No Trace is mandatory. Fire restrictions may prohibit campfires at any time — check daily with staff.
- **VEHICLES:** Not permitted inside camp beyond the parking area. Back into spaces. Emergency vehicle access must remain clear at all times.
- **MEDICATIONS:** All prescription medications must be surrendered to the Camp Health Officer at check-in. Stored securely per NCAP HS-508. No exceptions.
- **YOUTH PROTECTION:** All adults must have current YPT on file. Two-deep leadership required at all times. No one-on-one adult/youth contact.
- **WEEK 1 (Jun 1–5)** is a 5-DAY PROGRAM — Tuesday arrival. Weeks 2 & 3 are full Sunday-arrival weeks.

I. Welcome to Pirate Crew Adventures

Welcome aboard! Camp Lawton has been transformed into a Fleet of pirate ships for 2027. Every campsite is a Ship, every unit is a Pirate Crew, and every scout has a chance to earn their sea legs. This guide contains everything your unit needs to have a safe, successful, and memorable week.

The theme is built around the Golden Age of Piracy — emphasizing teamwork (the crew), outdoor skills (the voyage), and earned achievement (the treasure). All programming is land-based. Please review this guide fully before arrival and share key sections with your scouts and their families.

Pirate Theme Glossary

The Fleet	The whole camp community
Your Ship	Your unit's campsite
The Galley	Dining Hall
The Head	Latrines / restrooms
Your Quarters	Your tent or cabin
Captain's Quarters	SPL/Leader meeting location (posted at check-in)
Raise Colors	Morning flag ceremony
Retire Colors	Evening flag ceremony
Deck Swabbing	Post-meal cleanup duties
Galley Grub	Any meal
Pieces of Eight	Gold coins used in scavenger hunt

II. Arrival & Check-In

Check-In Procedure

- Arrive on the session's designated arrival day (Sunday for Weeks 2 & 3; Tuesday for Week 1) between 1:00 PM and 3:00 PM. Do not arrive early — staff setup is in progress.
- Back your vehicle into your parking space. Required for emergency vehicle egress — not a suggestion.
- Vehicles are NOT permitted inside camp beyond the designated parking area.
- Proceed to the check-in station with: unit roster, health forms, and all prescription medications.
- All medications surrendered to Camp Health Officer at check-in. Returned at check-out with signature (NCAP HS-508).
- Receive Ship Assignment (campsite), leader packet, and weekly schedule.
- Proceed to campsite for Ship Setup. Safety Brief begins at 3:00 PM — all scouts and leaders must attend.

Required Documentation — Bring for Every Participant

- BSA Annual Health & Medical Record Parts A, B, and C (completed within 12 months)
- Signed unit roster with emergency contact information for each participant
- Special dietary needs or medical accommodation documentation
- All prescription medications in original labeled containers with dosage instructions
- Proof of current Youth Protection Training for all registered adult leaders

ELECTRONIC HEALTH RECORDS — NCAP HS-503 (Revised Jan. 1, 2026)

- Camp Lawton is building electronic health record capability per HS-503. Paper forms remain fully acceptable for 2027.
- If submitting health records electronically in advance, confirm receipt with the Camp Director before your arrival date.
- All health information is confidential and accessed only by the Camp Health Officer and emergency medical personnel.

III. Camp Policies

National Forest Land — USFS Special Use Permit

Camp Lawton operates on National Forest land under a USFS Special Use Permit. Per NCAP AO-801, USFS permit conditions legally prevail over camp preferences. The following apply to all leaders, scouts, and visitors:

- LEAVE NO TRACE: Pack out all trash. Stay on established trails. Do not trample native vegetation. Respect wildlife — observe from a distance, never feed.
- CAMPFIRES: Subject to USFS fire restrictions at all times. Check with camp staff every morning. Fire bans can be issued without warning. Always have a no-flame alternative planned.
- GROUND DISTURBANCE: No digging, trenching, or staking without Camp Ranger approval. Follow posted instructions for tent stake placement.
- PETS: No pets within camp boundaries without USFS approval. Service animals with current documentation are permitted.
- FIREARMS & FIREWORKS: Prohibited on National Forest land. No personal firearms may be brought to camp under any circumstances.
- TRAIL USE: Group sizes on hiking trails may be restricted by your USFS permit. Confirm maximum group size for any off-road hike with the Camp Ranger before departure.
- WASTE DISPOSAL: Dispose of all waste at designated central waste stations. Pack out trash. Never pour liquid waste on the ground.
- WILDLIFE & FOOD: Store all food and scented items per USFS requirements. Report unusual wildlife activity to the Camp Ranger immediately.

Youth Protection

- All adults in camp must be registered Scouting America members with current Youth Protection Training on file
- Two-deep leadership required at all times — no one-on-one adult/youth contact, ever
- Showers, latrines, and changing areas are separated by gender and age group
- Report any suspected abuse immediately to the Camp Director and local law enforcement
- Electronic device use by youth is restricted to designated areas and times as posted by camp

Health & Safety

- Camp Health Officer (CHO) on duty all session hours per NCAP SQ-405. After-hours backup CHO designated — ask at check-in.
- First aid kits located at: the Health Lodge, each program area, and carried by all trek leaders
- Buddy System (NCAP HS-511) required for all scout movement throughout camp — brief your scouts at arrival
- Emergency assembly point posted at your Ship and at each program area entrance
- All serious incidents reported to Camp Director immediately per NCAP PD-112 tracking requirements

Firearms & Range Activities

Camp Lawton offers archery (PS-213) as a merit badge and program activity. Air rifle availability depends on two credentialed staff being present per PS-214 — confirm with Camp Director before your session.

- No personal bows, arrows, or range equipment may be brought to camp without prior written approval from the Camp Director
- The archery range location has been reviewed and approved consistent with the USFS Special Use Permit (AO-801)
- Range SOPs are posted at the range entrance and available from the Range Director

IV. Daily Schedule Overview — BSA Weeks

The schedule below shows the standard Monday–Thursday daily pattern. Sunday arrival and Friday/Saturday departure days differ — see your full schedule document for complete day-by-day timing. Week 1 (Jun 1–5) follows a condensed Tue–Sat version of this pattern.

6:00–6:30 AM	Staff Meeting (30 min) — all staff; not required for leaders unless invited
6:30 AM	Reveille
6:40–7:00 AM	Morning Flags (20 min)
7:10–7:45 AM	Galley Breakfast (35 min) · 30-min cleanup buffer follows
8:15–9:05 AM	Merit Badge Session 1 (50 min)
9:15–10:05 AM	Merit Badge Session 2 (50 min)
10:15–11:05 AM	Merit Badge Session 3 (50 min)
11:15–11:30 AM	Captain’s Challenge Staff Duel (15 min)
11:40 AM–12:25 PM	Galley Lunch (45 min) · 30-min cleanup buffer follows
12:55–1:25 PM	SPL & Leaders Meeting at Captain’s Quarters Scout Free Time (concurrent)
1:35–2:25 PM	Merit Badge Session 4 (50 min)
2:35–3:25 PM	Merit Badge Session 5 (50 min)
3:35–4:25 PM	Merit Badge Session 6 (50 min)
4:35–5:25 PM	Campsite Competition (varies by day)
5:35–5:55 PM	Evening Flags (20 min)
6:05–6:55 PM	Galley Dinner (50 min) · 30-min cleanup buffer follows
7:25 PM	Evening Program (varies by day)
9:00–9:45 PM	Taps — Lights Out (exact time varies by day)

Note: 10-minute transitions occur between every activity. 30-minute post-meal cleanup buffers occur after every meal. These are built into the schedule and are non-negotiable for safe and orderly camp operation.

V. Program Highlights

Evening Programs by Day

Sunday	Staff Campfire — staff perform skits, songs, storytelling. Scouts watch. Sets the theme for the week. Subject to USFS fire restrictions.
Monday	G-Rated Pirate Movie — Muppet Treasure Island (full film screening)
Tuesday	Karaoke Night
Wednesday	Pirate Lore & Stargazing (campfire subject to USFS fire restrictions)
Thursday	Youth Campfire — scouts perform pre-approved skits, songs, stories. Families may attend. Kit approval by staff required Thursday afternoon.
Friday	Camper Pirate Campfire (full program, 3:05–5:05 PM) — all content pre-approved Thursday

Campsite Competitions (4:35–5:25 PM Daily)

Monday	Pieces of Eight Scavenger Hunt — orienteering skills, hidden gold coins
Tuesday	Knot-Tying Challenge — Secure the Ship's Rigging
Wednesday	Pirate Shanty & Tale Prep — campsite creative time for Friday campfire
Thursday	Walk the Plank — Gaga Ball Tournament
Friday	Camper Pirate Campfire (extended program block — see schedule)

Captain's Challenge Staff Duel

Every day at 11:15 AM (15 min before lunch), camp staff compete in a lighthearted pirate-themed challenge — knot-tying races, riddle contests, skit battles. Scouts cheer from the gallery. A fun daily tradition that builds camp spirit.

Astronomy Talk — Pirates & The Celestial Seas

A 30-minute presenter-led astronomy program connecting celestial navigation to the Golden Age of Piracy. Covers Polaris and latitude, the longitude problem, dead reckoning, and constellation lore. Supports Astronomy Merit Badge requirements 4, 5, and 9. See separate Astronomy Talk document for full presenter notes.

Bead Program

Scouts can earn themed beads throughout the week for demonstrated skills. Bead categories include: Knots, Navigation, First Aid, Outdoor Skills, and Service. Leaders distribute beads — ask at the Trading Post for the bead criteria card.

VI. Leader Logistics

SPL & Leaders Meeting

Held daily at 12:55 PM at the Captain's Quarters (location posted in your leader packet). While leaders meet, scouts have supervised free time — trading post, campsite rest, or fellowship. Meetings run 30 minutes. All unit SPLs and adult leaders are expected to attend.

Communication

- Emergency contact number for camp provided in your leader packet at check-in and posted in your Ship
- Two-way radios issued to unit leaders daily — return each morning to the Trading Post
- Cell service on National Forest land may be limited — camp communication system is the primary channel
- All serious incidents must be reported to the Camp Director immediately per NCAP PD-112

Thursday Evening — Campfire Kit Approval

Thursday afternoon (7:25–8:25 PM) scouts organize their campfire kits for the Friday Camper Pirate Campfire. All skit content, songs, and stories must be reviewed and approved by a staff member before performance. This is a BSA requirement (PD-112 skit screening) and non-negotiable. Leaders should work with their scouts on content during Wednesday's Pirate Shanty & Tale Prep block.

Departure — Friday/Saturday

- Complete campsite inspection and check-out. Site must be left cleaner than found (USFS LNT requirement).
- Return all issued equipment (radios, first aid kits, site keys) to the Trading Post.
- Retrieve all medications from the Camp Health Officer with signature (HS-508).
- Collect any retained valuables from the camp safe.
- Receive departure clearance from Camp Director before leaving.
- Exit via main entrance only. Speed limit in camp and on access roads: 10 MPH.

VII. NCAP 2026 Quick Reference for Leaders

The standards below are most relevant to your unit's experience at camp. Staff are responsible for full compliance — this table helps you understand what to expect and what is required of your unit.

Standard	Topic	Leader Requirement
HS-501	Youth Protection	All adults must have current YPT. Two-deep required at all times. Report suspected abuse to Camp Director and law enforcement immediately.
HS-502	Unit Leadership	Two registered adult leaders required with your unit at all times. At least one must be 21+.
HS-503	Medical Records	BSA Health & Medical Record Parts A, B, C required for all participants. Electronic records accepted if pre-confirmed with camp.
HS-508	Medications	All prescription medications surrendered to CHO at check-in. No self-medication by youth. Returned with signature at check-out.
HS-511	Buddy System	Required for all scout movement in camp. Brief your scouts at arrival. Enforced at all program areas.
AO-801	Permits	USFS permit conditions prevail. All activities comply with Special Use Permit. LNT mandatory on National Forest land.

PD-107	Outdoor Ethics	Leave No Trace principles apply throughout camp. Stay on established trails. Pack out all waste.
PD-112	Program Safety	All campfire skit content must be staff-approved before performance. Serious incidents documented and reported to Camp Director.
PS-213	Archery	Range operates with certified supervision. Properly sized equipment (finger tabs, forearm guards) required for all participants. Range SOPs posted.
RP-551	MESH	Mental, Emotional & Social Health support infrastructure in place. Contact Camp Director if a scout needs additional support.

Appendix: Leave No Trace — National Forest Land Requirements

All activities at Camp Lawton must follow Leave No Trace principles as required by the USFS Special Use Permit and NCAP PD-107. Please brief your scouts on these principles at arrival.

LNT Principle	What It Means at Camp Lawton
1. Plan Ahead & Prepare	Know your activity boundaries. Check fire restrictions every morning with staff. Brief scouts on USFS rules before going out.
2. Travel on Durable Surfaces	Stay on established trails and cleared paths. Do not cut through native vegetation. Keep groups together.
3. Dispose of Waste Properly	Pack out all trash — including craft materials, food wrappers, and broken equipment. Dispose of all waste at designated central waste stations.
4. Leave What You Find	Do not collect rocks, plants, feathers, or natural materials. Do not move or stack rocks. Leave the forest as you found it.
5. Minimize Campfire Impacts	Use established fire rings only. Check USFS fire restriction status daily. Fully extinguish all fires — cold to the touch. Have a no-flame backup planned for every evening campfire.
6. Respect Wildlife	Observe animals from a distance. Never feed wildlife. Store all food and scented items properly. Report unusual wildlife to Camp Ranger.
7. Be Considerate of Others	Respect quiet hours. Keep noise levels appropriate. Leave program areas cleaner than you found them. Share trails courteously.